

A young man with dark hair, wearing a black cowboy hat and a light blue denim shirt with a star patch, is smiling and holding a computer monitor on a silver tray. The background is a dimly lit restaurant or bar with warm lighting and wooden furniture.

Serve Up that Desktop with Some SPICE

Here's a simple protocol that can really add some spice to the growing desktop virtualisation market.

Ask any person from the apparel world and they will all agree that "Fashion repeats itself!" Some will also hasten to add that new designers and manufacturing technology reinvent the earlier forms into styles relevant today. Personally, I feel that the length and breadth of some of the most fashionable garments are taking us back to the Stone Age.

Does this hold true for information technology as well? From the huge mainframes and minis of yesterday to powerful desktops, we seem to be coming back to an era of thin clients. Undoubtedly,

technology innovations have added their spice to this repetitive cycle in the evolution of technology (or so it seems to me).

Instead of a thick, fat, powerful computer sitting in some remote corner, cloud computing and server virtualisation has enabled us to concentrate technical horsepower in the data centre. Virtualisation on the ubiquitous x86 hardware has enabled organisations to optimise their IT rupees on hardware. The advent of TCP/IP, the Internet, and specifically the HTTP protocol and the browser, have enabled more and more software to be delivered as a service over a wide variety of devices.

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